

DAVID CARLTON ADAMS

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U.S. citizen; authorized to work in the United States without sponsorship; eligible for clearance.

Summary

Program operator and co-founder: co-created a commissioning organization from the ground up (2024, now incorporating), co-directed a nonprofit festival for six years on a single public-funder recompetes, and co-lead a creative program inside two Washington, DC correctional facilities. Builds events from nothing, sets the budget before anything is booked, and has grown, changed, and handed off programs. Also builds and operates multi-agent AI systems with explicit trust boundaries, human decision gates, and a standing evaluation-and-audit practice.

Programs, Convenings & Talent Development

New Uncertainty Collective — *Co-founder, 2024–Present*

Co-founded and co-lead a commissioning, presenting, publishing, and recording organization from zero: built the initial network, developed institutional partnerships (Peabody Institute; NYU GSAS, in a concert series led by a co-founder), and have co-run **~10 public events since 2024**. Leading the 501(c)(3) legal standup (in process with DLA Piper) alongside programming and finance operations. **Latest scale decision:** secured LIGAMENT Duo as a commissioning partner (Aug 2026) for four new works.

Project Poetic Justice (now under New Uncertainty Collective) — *Co-lead, 2026; Team member, founding cycle 2025*

Multi-week creative program inside two Washington, DC correctional facilities: a constrained, high-compliance institutional environment with security review and gatekeeper approval at every step. Joined the founding cycle as a team member, then co-led the second cycle after the program moved under NUC's umbrella; now represent it publicly, including JHU's *Rooted in Baltimore* exhibitor day (Sep 2026). Program record: **~24 original works premiered** across the two cycles, co-created with incarcerated writers, performed inside and for DC audiences.

Fast Forward Austin (501(c)(3)) — *Co-director, 2017–2023*

Six years of end-to-end program leadership for an annual new-music festival, a convening of regional and visiting artists run with no staff: grant strategy, budgets, venue contracting, artist logistics, volunteer coordination, across **seven documented productions**. Ran operations alongside a founding director in year one, then carried the organization as lead until relocating and recruiting two successor co-directors rather than let it drift. Sustained the annual public-funder recompetes (a single City of Austin Cultural Arts contract supplied **94–100%** of a **\$6,000–\$7,000** annual budget with no staff or overhead line) while holding artist payout at **73–81%** of every dollar spent, every year on record. City of Austin support totaled **\$32,107** in direct Core grants (FY16–FY21) plus **\$22,606** in COVID-era relief funding secured for the organization.

Faculty Learning Community: AI, Artistry, and Education — Peabody Institute, Johns Hopkins University — *Co-lead, 2026–27*

Co-designing and co-leading a year-long faculty cohort program with two colleagues; lead the *AI in Practice* strand.

Private Music Instructor — independent practice built to a peak of **60 students/week**; sourced, priced, and retained every client as sole operator | *2008–Present*

AI Systems Work — *independently built and operated*

Multi-agent operations platform — *architect and operator, 2026–Present*

Designed and operate a self-administered multi-agent system composing calendar, task, and external research/opportunity feeds into a daily briefing: **178 days of briefings delivered since March 2026**, no human assembly step. Runs **29 scheduled autonomous processes** across launchd/cron; single source of truth across **78 tracked projects**, with a decision queue and audit log built in-house.

AI governance and trust-boundary architecture — *governance architect and system owner, 2026–Present*
Built tiered autonomy for a system reading untrusted sources (scraped reports, agent output, inbound email) and writing to outbound channels: read-only holds on untrusted input, human approval gates at every external boundary, rotating integrity audits on a 7-week lane rotation. Commissioned a cross-model adversarial review of the architecture and translated findings into enforcement-backed controls.

Evaluation & verification practice — adversarial pre-ship test suites; rotating integrity audits over untrusted-input lanes; render-and-inspect output verification.

Other Work Experience

Peabody Institute, Johns Hopkins University — Baltimore, MD

Adjunct Faculty, Music Theory (Fall 2026); *Graduate Teaching Associate* (2024–2026); *Graduate Assistant* (2020–2024)

Instructor of record across five undergraduate theory terms (**54 students taught**).

Adjunct Faculty, Towson University — musicianship | *Fall 2024*

Music Program Director, International School of Texas — founding-year IB MYP program design and delivery, **~20 students** | 2019–2020

Research & Writing

- **Doctoral research**, Johns Hopkins University (2022–2026): analyzed the stylistic and institutional boundaries between experimental rock and contemporary classical music.
 - **Funded proposals and reporting**: City of Austin Cultural Arts (multi-year awards), Peabody Professional Development Grants (2021, 2023, 2026).
 - **Fulbright research proposal** (Germany, 2024–25): authored and selected as national semi-finalist.
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Education

Doctor of Musical Arts in Composition, cognate in Computer Music — Peabody Institute, Johns Hopkins University, 2026

Master of Music in Composition — Peabody Institute, Johns Hopkins University, 2022

Bachelor of Music in Composition — University of Texas at Austin, 2014

Coursework in mathematics, physics, chemistry, nuclear engineering — Texas A&M, 2001–02

Tools & Languages

Documents & data: Google Workspace (Docs, Sheets, Slides) including the Workspace APIs; Microsoft Excel and PowerPoint; in-house relational project and decision tracker with audit log (Airtable-equivalent).

AI & light programming: Claude Code and Claude API multi-agent design; MCP integrations; evaluation gates and guardrails; Python, shell, Git.

Languages: English (native); French (professional working); Japanese (conversational); Russian (elementary).
